HEXLEY CHEMICALS

Control of Work Policy

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1. Purpose

This policy says how Hexley Chemicals controls hazardous work at Thornmere Works with permits to work: who opens the review of a permit request and who decides it, how a request is screened against its permit type's own standard and its linked type's, when a SIMOPS review must come first, what each decision means and what it sends out, how the request queue is ordered, and what the control room may be told.

It applies to every request made through the site portal, the contractor app or scanned paper for hot work, confined space entry, electrical isolation, work at height or excavation. Each request is reviewed under the permit standard of its own permit type, and of its linked permit type where it has one.

2. Roles

- **Permit Coordinator** - works in the permit office, opens the review of a request from the request queue and states what the review should look at; the review, with the decision it recommends, then waits for an Area Authority. A review is opened once for each request, and a Permit Coordinator never decides one.
- **Area Authority** - is appointed for the plant areas of one area group, as section 3 sets out; may open a review of a request in those areas, and decides any review of a request in those areas that they did not open: issues the permit, returns the request to its requester, or refers it for a SIMOPS review.
- **Performing authority** - the supervisor of the contractor's work party, who requests the permit through a channel, answers for the request and the documents attached to it, and leads the work under the permit once it is issued.
- **SIMOPS panel** - the Area Authority, the Permit Coordinator and the performing authorities of the permits live in the area, who meet for every request referred for a SIMOPS review and agree how the jobs are kept apart, in order or in place, before the permit is issued.
- **Control Room Operator** - runs the plant from the control room, and asks about the permit standards, this policy, the Permit Rules and the statement guides, about a permit request only as section 11 allows, and about a plant area only as section 12 allows.

3. Separation of opening and deciding

The person who opens a review may not decide it. Every review is decided by an Area Authority appointed for the request's plant area who did not open it, and the decision is recorded with the Area Authority's account.

Each Area Authority is appointed for one area group: the process units - Reactor House A, Reactor House B, Distillation Unit, Solvent Recovery, Chlorine Unit, Caustic Evaporation, Drum Filling, Flare Area, East Pipe Bridge and West Pipe Bridge; the storage areas - Tank Farm North, Tank Farm South, Road Loading Bay and Rail Sidings; the utilities - Effluent Treatment, Boiler House, Cooling Towers, Compressor House, Main Substation and Water Treatment; or the non-process areas - Site Roads and Drains, Engineering Workshops, Central Warehouse, Laboratory, Control Building, Administration Block, Gatehouse, Fire Station and Weighbridge. Two Area Authorities are appointed for each group, so that one can decide what the other opened.

A recommendation, however it was produced, is only a recommendation. Nothing is sent, and no request is issued, returned or referred, until the decision is recorded. Tools may screen the request, read the documents, work out the figures and draft the permit document and the briefing, but issuing a permit to work is never a machine's to decide.

4. Permits, linked permits and the register

Every job of one of the five permit types needs a permit before it starts. A job that needs two permit types - hot work at height, or entry into a vessel whose agitator drive is isolated - is requested once, with the second as its linked permit type, and must meet both standards. No permit type is linked to itself.

The live permit register lists every permit issued on site and not yet handed back, Live or Suspended. An Area Authority, or the control room, may suspend a live permit at any time - on a gas alarm, a process upset, a site alarm, conflicting work, an unsafe condition or high wind - and its work stops until the Area Authority revalidates it with the gas tested again. A suspended permit does not count as live for the SIMOPS triggers.

A permit stays valid for up to 1.3 times its planned work hours. Work that will run longer is extended by the Area Authority before the permit runs out, and the job log records the permit as completed after extension.

5. What is reviewed

Every request is reviewed in four parts:

1 **The requirements.** Each requirement of the permit type's own standard, and of its linked type's, Met, Not met or Not documented on the latest revision of the request, read as the Permit Rules set out.

2 **The SIMOPS triggers.** Whether a SIMOPS review must come first, as section 6 sets out.

3 **The statements.** Every sentence of every document attached to the request, read with the statement guide for its type where it has one. A gas testing sentence whose reading differs from the request's, or gives a reading the request left blank, is flagged for the Area Authority.

4 **The figures.** The suspension likelihood and the expected work hours, as section 10 describes.

Each permit type's requirements are read from its own standard and from no other document. The five permit standards share one layout and many of the same sentences, and the hot work and confined space entry standards read almost alike, so the standard is always chosen by the permit type on the request, and by its linked permit type.

6. The SIMOPS triggers

A SIMOPS review must come first when any one of these applies:

- a **conflicting live permit**: a permit live in the same plant area, in the live permit register, whose permit type or linked type conflicts with the request's own or linked type. Hot work conflicts with confined space entry and with excavation, each way round, and no other pair conflicts;
- a **live process unit**: the request, or its linked type, is hot work or confined space entry, and the process unit in the plant area is neither shut down nor an area without process plant;
- **high voltage**: the request, or its linked type, is an electrical isolation of a system above 1,000 volts.

The permits live in the area are counted from the live permit register, and a suspended permit is never counted. A hot work request in an area where a confined space entry is live counts one conflicting live permit; with that entry suspended it counts none; and work at height or an electrical isolation live beside it never conflicts.

A blank answer never lets a request slip past a SIMOPS review: a blank process unit status counts as operating, and a blank system voltage counts as above 1,000 volts.

7. The three decisions

The screening gives an assessment. Any requirement Not met or Not documented, under the request's own standard or its linked type's, makes it RETURN TO REQUESTER; otherwise any SIMOPS trigger makes it REFER FOR SIMOPS REVIEW; otherwise it is ISSUE PERMIT.

The Area Authority chooses one of three decisions, each open only as set out here:

- **ISSUE PERMIT** - the work may go ahead as requested, and the permit document and the work party briefing of section 8 are written. Open only when the assessment is ISSUE PERMIT: every requirement Met and no SIMOPS trigger.
- **RETURN TO REQUESTER** - the request goes back to its performing authority with the rework request that section 8 describes. Always open.
- **REFER FOR SIMOPS REVIEW** - the request goes to the SIMOPS panel with its review, where the jobs in the area are kept apart and an exception can be argued. Always open.

A decision that is not open is refused, and so is a decision by the person who opened the review, a decision by an Area Authority not appointed for the request's plant area, a decision on a review already decided, and a decision while another is being recorded.

The request's record moves from awaiting a decision to issued, returned to requester or referred for SIMOPS review, and keeps the review, the decision, the Area Authority, the documents written and every step of the review. A returned request, once put right, is sent again as the next revision of the same request, and that revision is reviewed afresh.

8. Documents and the SIMOPS brief

When an Area Authority issues a permit, the permit document is written to the performing authority, as section 7 of the permit type's standard sets out, and then the work party briefing, as its section 8 sets out.

When a request is returned, a rework request is written to the performing authority. It names every requirement not met or not documented, with the request's own answers and the answers it needs, the "Documentation to provide" section of each standard it was screened under, and every statement sentence flagged against the request, to be settled by the performing authority. No briefing is written.

When a request is referred, a SIMOPS brief is built from the review's record: the request, its requirements and their results, the SIMOPS triggers with every conflicting permit live in the area by its permit reference, the statements' flags and the figures. Nothing is written to the performing authority until the SIMOPS review has been held.

Neither the permit document, the rework request nor the work party briefing carries a figure from a model, and the briefing never names any member of Hexley's staff.

9. The request queue

The request queue lists every open request - every request in the live queue - whatever its review has reached. Requests whose permit type or linked type is confined space entry come first, because the rescue cover must be arranged before anyone enters, and every other request after them, each group in order of its permit reference, so that the oldest request is reviewed first. The queue is never ordered by a model's figure.

A request in the queue is awaiting review until its review is opened, awaiting a decision once the review has been written, and then issued, returned to requester or referred for SIMOPS review once an Area Authority has decided it; a decided request stays in the queue with its decision.

10. The two figures

Two figures are shown to the Area Authority beside every review. They are advisory: the decisions open come from the requirements and the SIMOPS triggers alone, neither figure decides a request, and neither appears in a permit document, a rework request or a briefing.

- **The suspension likelihood** - how likely permits like this one have been to be suspended before their work was completed, worked out from the permit history with the request's requirement results, the permits live beside it and its SIMOPS triggers. It is shown with a band: HIGH from 0.40, MEDIUM from 0.20, and LOW below.
- **The expected work hours** - how long jobs like this one have really taken from the permit's issue to its hand-back, worked out from the job logs, to one decimal of an hour. An extension is expected when the expected work hours are more than 1.3 times the performing authority's planned work hours.

A job's hours run from the permit's issue to its hand-back: a returned request's rework is never counted, and the hours a suspended permit lost to its stop are.

11. What the control room may be told

A Control Room Operator asks about the permit standards, this policy, the Permit Rules and the statement guides, and is answered from those documents with the documents named. A question the documents do not answer is answered with one line: "The control of work documents do not answer that question."

About a permit request named by its reference, a Control Room Operator may be told its permit type, its plant area and its status and, once the permit is issued, what the control room needs to run the plant around the work: the equipment tag the work is on and the size of the work party. The review's requirements, statements and figures are for the permit office and the Area Authorities: an Area Authority or a Permit Coordinator who asks about a request is given the review's record.

Whether a permit is likely to be suspended, or how long its work will take, is never for the control room to be told. Asked, a Control Room Operator is answered with one line and nothing more: "A permit request is decided by an Area Authority, and the control room is not told whether a permit is likely to be suspended or how long its work will take."

A reference that matches no open request is answered: "No open permit request is recorded under reference ...", with the reference written as a permit reference wherever it can be read.

12. Figures about a plant area

Asked how many hot work, confined space entry, electrical isolation, work at height or excavation permits have been worked in a plant area, anyone - Area Authority, Permit Coordinator or Control Room Operator - is given the figure only when at least five permits make it up. The figure is the number of permits of that permit type in that plant area, counted from the permit history by the permit type alone - a permit only linked to that type is not counted - and a request in the queue is never counted.

Below five, the figure could point to one contractor's crew and the people in it, and everyone hears one fixed line instead: "Figures about permits in a plant area are shared only where at least five permits make them up." The rule protects the people who do the work, whoever asks, and the figure comes from the records, never from a model.

13. Records

Every review keeps the requirements and their results, the SIMOPS triggers and the permits counted, the statements' sentences and flags, the figures, the coordinator's request, the recommendation, the decision and the documents written or the SIMOPS brief, and every model call made for the review and its documents, with the tokens it used and the time it took; the run behind the review keeps the request as it was read. The record is kept for audit and is never changed after the decision.

The Permit Office owns this policy, reviews it every twelve months and issues any amendment as a new issue of this document, replacing every earlier issue.